

quickly if the difficulty of the problem is not increased. Keeping a steady cadence of 10 minutes for blocks means that transactions will be incorporated into Bitcoin's blockchain in a timely manner, and it also mathematically meters the supply issuance of bitcoin.

11. Here the term refers to the transaction in a block that pays the miner, whereas it is most commonly associated with a company called Coinbase.
12. Astute investors may realize that the halving doesn't happen exactly every four years. The reason for this is because if lots of machines are being added to the mining network, then block times will average faster than 10 minutes before the difficulty is reset again. This speeds up the time between every 210,000 blocks.
13. <https://blockchain.info/charts/total-bitcoins>.
14. The term was even used for one of the first books written about Bitcoin, *Digital Gold: Bitcoin and the Inside Story of the Misfits and Millionaires Trying to Reinvent Money*, by Nathaniel Popper, Harper Collins, 2015.
15. <https://namecoin.org/>.
16. <https://bit.namecoin.org/>.
17. <https://bitcointalk.org/index.php?topic=1790.0>.
18. https://litecoin.info/History_of_cryptocurrency.
19. https://litecoin.info/Comparison_between_Litecoin_and_Bitcoin/Alternative_work_in_progress_version.
20. <https://coinmarketcap.com/historical/20170101/>.
21. <http://ryanfugger.com/>.